SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE

EPISODE 15 • STUDY NOTES

Advanced Relationships in Salesforce Self, Hierarchical, Many-to-Many & External Lookup

A complete, easy-to-revise breakdown of the video — with tables, multiple diagrams, and step-by-step demos.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- Self Relationship
- Hierarchical Relationship
- Many-to-Many Relationship
- Junction Object
- External Lookup Relationship
- All 5 types compared

1 Introduction 0:00 – 0:40

After covering Lookup and Master-Detail — the two most common relationship types — this episode wraps up the remaining relationship types every Salesforce Admin should know.

> **Covered today:** Self Relationship • Hierarchical Relationship • Many-to-Many Relationship • Junction Object • External Lookup Relationship

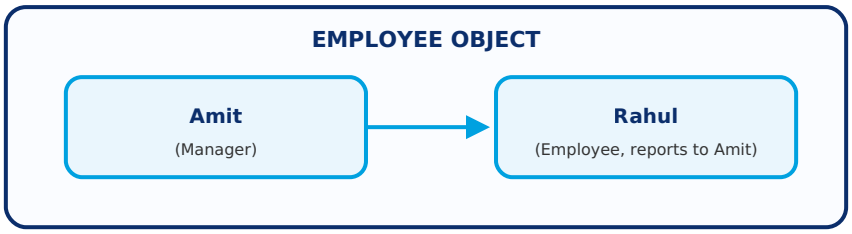
2 Self Relationship 0:40 – 3:00

Self Relationship

A special type of **Lookup Relationship** where an object creates a relationship with itself — the parent and child records both belong to the **same object**.

Real-Life Example: Employee → Manager

Every employee has a manager — and that manager is *also* an employee. Instead of a separate "Manager" object, the **Employee** object simply references another Employee record.



Both "Amit" and "Rahul" are records of the same Employee object — connected via a Lookup field named "Manager".

Practical Demo

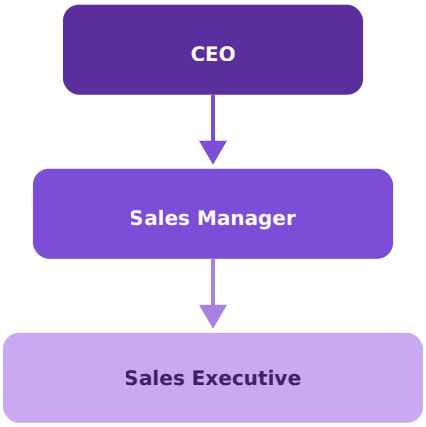
1. Open the **Employee** object → create a new field.
2. Choose **Lookup Relationship**.
3. Select **Employee** itself as the related object.
4. Save the field as **Manager**.
5. Create two Employee records, and assign one as the manager of the other.

3 Hierarchical Relationship 3:00 – 6:00

Hierarchical Relationship

Also a relationship within the same object — but available **only on the User object**. Salesforce uses it to represent reporting structures inside an organization.

Real-Life Example: Reporting Structure



Key Features

Feature	Detail
Availability	Only on the **User** object
Purpose	Creates Manager–Employee hierarchies
Use case	Approvals and reporting structures
Supports	Organizational reporting

Practical Demo

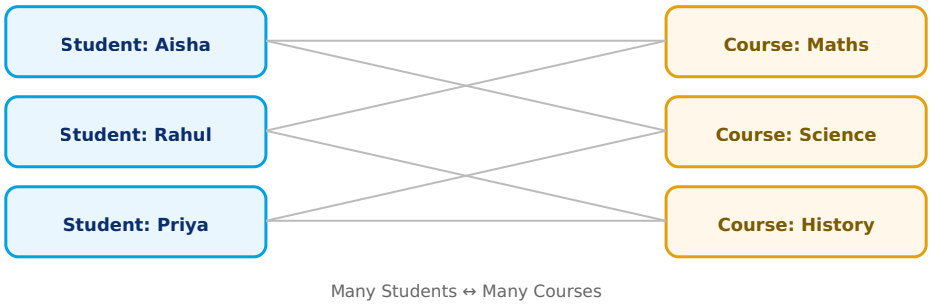
1. Go to the **User** object.
2. Create or edit a user.
3. Populate the **Manager** field.
4. Salesforce now understands who reports to whom.

4 Many-to-Many Relationship 6:00 – 9:30

Many-to-Many Relationship

Sometimes one record relates to **many** records, and those records also relate to **many others**. Neither Lookup nor Master-Detail can directly model this alone.

Real-Life Example: Students & Courses

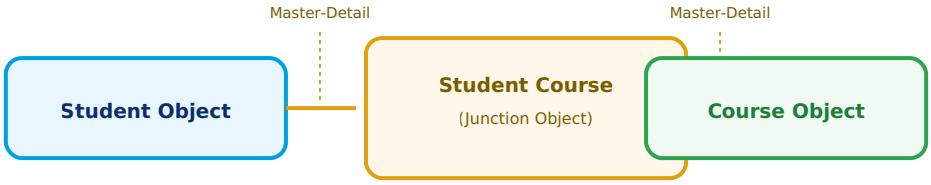


One Student can enroll in many Courses. One Course can have many Students.

5 Junction Object 9:30 – 12:30

> **Important:** Salesforce has no field type called "Many-to-Many Relationship." Instead, we build it using a **Junction Object** — a custom object containing **two Master-Detail Relationships**.

How the Junction Object Connects Everything



Object	Role
Student	Parent 1 (Master)
Course	Parent 2 (Master)
Student Course	Junction Object (Child of both)

The result: one Student can join many Courses, and one Course can have many Students — a true Many-to-Many Relationship.

Practical Demo

1. Create three objects: **Student**, **Course**, and **Student Course**.
2. Open **Student Course**.
3. Create the first **Master-Detail** field pointing to **Student**.
4. Create a second **Master-Detail** field pointing to **Course**.
5. Click **Save**.
6. Create records — Students and Courses are now connected through the Junction Object.

6 External Lookup Relationship 12:30 – 15:00

External Lookup Relationship

Used when Salesforce needs to connect its data with **External Objects** — data that lives outside Salesforce.

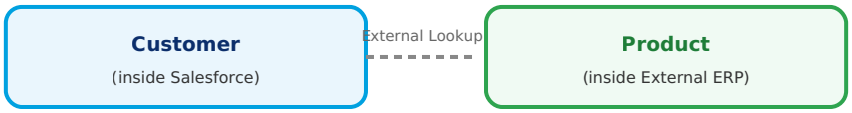
Where External Data Might Live

ERP Systems | External Databases | SAP | Microsoft SQL Server

Real-Life Example

Customer (Salesforce) ↔ Product (ERP System)

Your company stores **Product** data in an ERP system, while Salesforce stores **Customer** data. An External Lookup Relationship links a Customer record to Product information **without copying** that data into Salesforce.



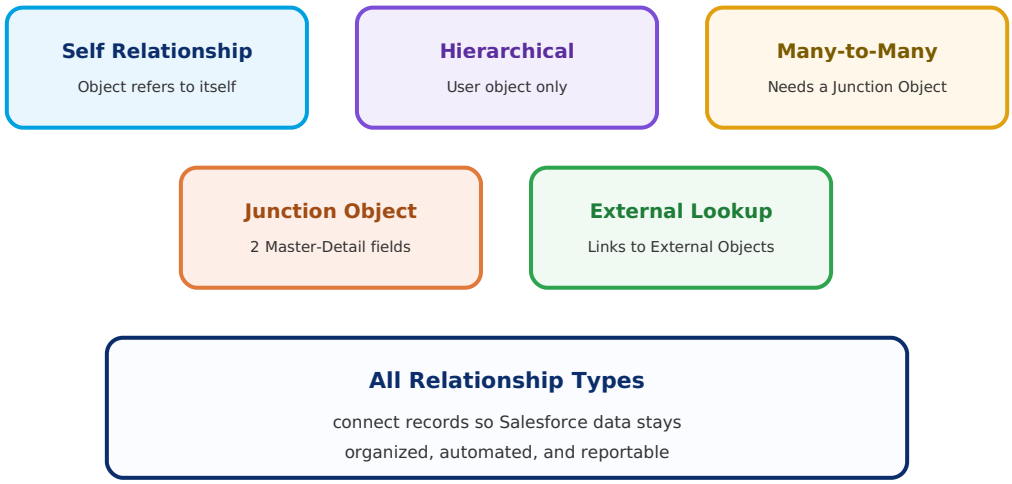
Key Features

Feature	Detail
Connects	Salesforce data with External Objects
Uses	External IDs
Best for	Large external data sources
Benefit	Prevents unnecessary data duplication

Practical Demo

1. Open an **External Object**.
2. Create a new relationship field.
3. Choose **External Lookup Relationship**.
4. Select the related Salesforce object.
5. Click **Save** — Salesforce can now reference data stored outside the platform.

7 All 5 Relationship Types — Recap Diagram



8 Episode Summary 15:00 – 16:00

- ✔ **Self Relationship** — a Lookup where an object relates to itself (e.g. Employee → Manager)
- ✔ **Hierarchical Relationship** — same-object relationship, only on the User object, for reporting structures
- ✔ **Many-to-Many Relationship** — when many records on both sides need to connect (e.g. Students ↔ Courses)
- ✔ **Junction Object** — a custom object with 2 Master-Detail relationships that makes Many-to-Many possible
- ✔ **External Lookup Relationship** — connects Salesforce data to data stored in External Objects, avoiding duplication

> ***That's a wrap on Relationships!*** *You've now covered all the major relationship types used in Salesforce Administration — Lookup, Master-Detail, Self, Hierarchical, Many-to-Many, Junction Object, and External Lookup.*